territory under conditions which will guarantee freedom of conscience and religion, subject only to the maintenance of public order and morals, the prohibition of abuses, such as the slave trade, the arms traffic and the liquor traffic, and the prevention of the establishment of fortifications or military and naval bases and of military training of the natives for other than police purposes and the defence of territory, and will also secure equal opportunities for the trade and commerce of other Members of the League.

There are territories, such as South-West Africa and certain of the South Pacific Islands, which, owing to the sparseness of their population, or their small size, or their remoteness from the centres of civilisation, or their geographical contiguity to the territory of the Mandatory, and other circumstances, can be best administered under the laws of the Mandatory as integral portions of its territory, subject to the safeguards above mentioned in the interests of the indigenous population.

In every case of mandate, the Mandatory shall render to the Council an annual report in reference to the territory committed to its charge.

The degree of authority, control, or administration to be exercised by the Mandatory shall, if not previously agreed upon by the Members of the League, be explicitly defined in each case by the Council.

A permanent Commission shall be constituted to receive and examine the annual reports of the Mandatories and to advise the Council on all matters relating to the observance of the mandates [emphases added].

That the ‘sacred trust of civilisation’ required ‘advanced nations’ to hand-hold and tutor former colonies (which were referred to as ‘backward’ instead of ‘uncivilised’) so that they could deal with ‘modernity’, a condition distinctly created by the Christian European coloniser, represents coloniality at its peak.

I will now place before the reader extracts from material leading to the Paris Peace Conference of 1919 to show that the reference to civilisation in Article 22 of the League’s Covenant was not without significance or context. For starters, although the United States of America chose not to become a formal member of the League, here is an extract from the Bible-inspired speech delivered by the 27th President of the United States (1909–